CST500 - Graduate Proseminar

CST 500 (Graduate Proseminar) Syllabus

Course Information

Course Details

- **Course Title:** Graduate Proseminar
- **Course Number:** CST 500
- **Meeting Location:** Physical
- **Units:** 2

Course Description

This course introduces key skills and topics for success in a master's program in Computer Science. Students will develop competencies in advanced technical communication, research methodologies, and professional ethics. Additional topics include analyzing research papers, formulating research questions, and presenting technical content. Collaborative projects and discussions will prepare students for academic research, professional practice, and career development.

Materials

- Course textbook: "The Craft of Research" by Wayne C. Booth, Gregory G. Colomb, and Joseph M. Williams

Technology Requirements

Students must have access to: - A computer (not "chromebook" or similar) with reliable internet connection - Access to Canvas learning management system

Course Objectives

At the end of this class, you should be able to:

1. Demonstrate proficiency in advanced technical communication and presentation skills
2. Apply research methodologies and evaluate scholarly literature in computer science
3. Understand and apply professional ethics principles in computing contexts
4. Formulate clear research questions and design appropriate research approaches

Grading

There are three groups of assignments, briefly described in the table below. **Getting below a 40% in any of these three groups will result in failing the class.**

Assignment Kind	Value
Projects	20%
Exams	20%

Assignment Kind	Value
Participation	60%

Projects

Projects will take the form of programming assignments, group research projects, and independent research.

Exams

Exams will cover material from class and from any assigned reading, as well as draw from knowledge gained during projects.

Participation

Class is expected to be highly interactive, with students actively answering and asking questions, as well as participating in discussion groups. Therefore, attendance is required, as well as participation in all in-class activities. These activities may take the form of research presentations, peer feedback sessions, professional development workshops, and collaborative discussions on ethics and research methodology.

Grade Assignment

Grades as assigned based on the standard ranges, which are outlined below.

Grade Range	Letter Grade
$[97, \infty)$	A+
$[93, 97)$	A
$[90, 93)$	A-
$[87, 90)$	B+
$[83, 87)$	B
$[80, 83)$	B-
$[77, 80)$	C+
$[73, 77)$	C
$[70, 73)$	C-
$[60, 70)$	D
$[0, 60)$	F

Syllabus Change Policy

This syllabus is subject to change at the instructor's discretion to enhance learning or accommodate unforeseen circumstances. Students will be notified of any substantive changes (such as changes to due dates, point values of assignments, or major policy modifications) via Canvas announcement and/or email at least one week in advance when possible.

The process for syllabus changes: 1. Instructor identifies need for change 2. Revised syllabus section is prepared 3. Students are notified via Canvas and email 4. Change takes effect after notification period

Students are responsible for staying current with any announced changes to the syllabus.